SCHOOL OF NATURAL SCIENCES
AND MATHEMATICS

THE UNIVERSITY OF TEXAS AT DALLAS

PHYSICS

800 West Campbell Road, SCI 10, RICHARDSON, TEXAS 75080

utdallas.edu/physics

January 30, 2026

Dear Samyak Shrestha:

It is my pleasure to inform you that you are being offered a **Teaching Assistantship** position for the Spring 2026 term to complete your studies in the Physics Department at the University of Texas at Dallas. The amount of your award will be $2,400.00 per month and will run January 1, 2026, through May 15, 2026. Your appointment carries a full tuition waiver for 9 credit hours for the Spring 2026 semester. Subject to budgetary constraints, you can expect your appointment to be renewed in subsequent semesters provided you make substantial and satisfactory progress toward your degree and maintain in good academic standing with a 3.0 GPA.

In accepting this offer you agree to abide by the following terms and conditions *(you must initial each line)*:

_____ 1. You will be obligated to work 20 hours per week as assigned by the Department.

_____ 2. You are not allowed to accept any employment, inside or outside the university, during the period in which you serve as a TA. You are accepting the obligations to fulfill your duties through the completion of the term.

_____ 3. You will be required to complete an approved minimum 9-graduate-hour course load in your degree plan each fall/spring semesters and 0-3 hours in summer (as required). You must be physically on campus to receive tuition and stipend of TA appointment.

_____ 4. The faculty supervisors for your TA appointment will be **Dr. Paul Macalevey and Dr. Lamya Saleh.** You will report to these supervisors for details on your duties.

_____ 5. I understand that data, laboratory notebooks, computer programs, sample collections and research products and technical information in any form are the property of the University and must be returned to the Principal Investigator/Project Director, Program Head or Dean immediately upon request or upon termination.

_____ 6. Your tuition and International Student Service fee of $150.00 (if applicable) will be funded; however, your student insurance beginning with Fall 2022 is explained at https://bursar.utdallas.edu/tuition/other-charges/ see RA / TA / GA Health Insurance.

_____ 7. If you do not report for your duties to your supervisor by the first day of your term of employment (or by first day classes start at the latest), your contract will be breached. You will be placed on non-medical leave (without pay) until you are able to report to your supervisor or your supervisor has the option to terminate your employment for this term.

_____ 8. Satisfactory performance as a TA is required *through the end of the semester*. If you plan to graduate this semester, you must still successfully complete all of your TA duties for this term before you leave. If you leave for any reason without the written permission of the Physics Department Head before you have completed your TA duties for the semester, this will be considered a breach of contract.

_____ 9. **First-Time TAs Only:** Prior to the start of the Spring 2026 semester, you are required to attend several orientation classes. Failure to attend these orientations may void your assistantship offer. For messages regarding orientation dates and times, you must monitor your UTD email account and the Graduate Studies webpage: http://www.utdallas.edu/ogs/.

_____ 10. **Benefits Information:**
Research Assistants/Teaching Assistants are eligible to enroll in the UT Select benefits program. **Enrollment or changes to insurance coverage must be made within 31 days from the date of hire, rehire or change of hours from less than 20 per week to at least 20 hours per week**, or you will be unable to enroll until the annual enrollment on July 15-July 31 next year, with effective coverage on September 1. To enroll or waive medical coverage and be eligible for the 1/2 premium sharing to apply towards dental, vision and AD&D costs, or discuss your benefit options, please set-up an appointment with one of the Benefits Administrators by sending an email to benefits@utdallas.edu. For detailed online information about your benefits, you can access the benefits information and the Benefits Packet for TA benefits eligible through these links: http://www.utdallas.edu/hr/benefits/packets/

_____ 11. **Notice:** *Violation of any of the above terms and conditions or resignation of your assistantship prior to the end of the semester will be regarded by the University as a breach of contract.*

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We congratulate you on the excellent academic record that has earned you this honor and hope that you will accept our offer to join the UTD community. Please let us know how we can further assist you with this important decision.

Sincerely,

Dr. G. Andrés Cisneros, Department Head and Professor
Department of Physics

To ACCEPT, please initial each item 1-11 on page 1, and fill all 4 spaces below on this page, including your signature. Please scan and return this letter via email to Debra Goss, debra.goss@utdallas.edu. **Your reply is requested on or before February 9, 2026.**

To DECLINE, please sign your name under the declination line and inform Debra Goss via email at your earliest opportunity, so that we may offer this award to another qualified student.

***ACCEPTANCE:**

I **accept** your offer with the conditions stated above and agree to fulfill my responsibilities until the end of the appointment period. **(You must return both pages of this letter.)**

Print Name _____ UTD Net ID _____

Signature _____ Date _____

***DECLINATION:**

I chose to **decline** your offer at this time.

Print Name _____ UTD Net ID _____

Signature _____ Date _____